

Week One Readings for Participants

Set Aside Prayer: *"God, Please help me set aside everything I think I know about myself, my disease, the 12 steps, and especially You, So I may have an open mind and a new experience of all these things. Please let me see the truth".*

We have some readings for you throughout the Workshop:

They are from three different sources: The Big Book of Alcoholics Anonymous, The Steps We Took, by Joe McQ and The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions.

"Next we launched out on a course of vigorous action, the first step of which is a personal house cleaning, which many of us had never attempted. Though our decision was a vital and crucial step, it could have little permanent effect unless at once followed by a strenuous effort to face, and be rid of, the things in ourselves which had been blocking us. Our liquor was but a symptom. So we had to get down to causes and conditions."

"Therefore, we started upon a personal inventory. THIS WAS STEP FOUR. A business which takes no regular inventory usually goes broke. Taking a commercial inventory is a fact-finding and fact-facing process. It is an effort to discover the truth about the stock-in-trade. One object is to disclose damages or unsalable goods, to get rid of them promptly and without regret. If the owner of the business is to be successful, he cannot fool himself about values.

We did exactly the same thing with our lives. We took stock honestly. First, we searched out the flaws in our make-up, which caused our failure. Being convinced that self, manifested in various ways, was what had defeated us, we considered its common manifestations." The Big Book, p.63-64

Joe McQ, on page 61 in his book, The Steps We Took

"We keep our minds on this predominant thought: We list all the names of people or institutions or principles for whom we have resentments. We make this list before we add anything about what the resentment is. We write just the names of all the people or things we have resentments against, left column, top to bottom, one thing at a time, just the names. We can remember these. We exhaust all of the resentments we have, identifying them by the names of people.

A mistake a lot of people make here is trying to list a person's name, then going right across the page to the next columns and analyzing the resentment. But this means we have to change our minds four times as we list each resentment, to think about four different things about each resentment. This inevitably leads to confusion. It is better to

name everyone and everything that we resent first, just thinking about one resentment at a time, working from top to bottom, of this column. Then we move over and start the next column."

Joe McQ continues to explain Column Two this way...

"So it is simple. We ask first, "Who are the people and things that I resent?" When we've finished making this list, we go on to the next column, and to the next most vivid thing in our memory, "What did he or she do to me?" We don't usually have any trouble remembering this either!! Beside each name, in the second column, we put down the cause associated with that person or thing. These are very vivid; everyone readily remembers them. Some of them we have been replaying in our minds for years and years. We know what they are. We put all these down from top to bottom. " page 61